

always mean that this is where the image will appear to be more affected. By rotating your filter, you can toggle between angles that appear most polarised, and you should keep looking at the camera's LCD or through its viewfinder to continuously foresee results. As the result primarily depends on the angle, the image can appear to be uneven when using wide angle lens. Since some portions of the scene may be in a direction directly of the sun while others might be at a right angle, a polariser can cause one side of the image to have a stronger effect while leaving the other side without any visible changes in composition. Another characteristic that you're likely to notice with a polariser is how it increases colour saturation, resulting in greener foliage, deeper blue skies and more intensely coloured flowers – every photographer's dream! One of its most useful and visible effects is its removal of reflections and isolation of objects which are wet, underwater or behind windows.

Reduction in reflection also has a direct consequence on reduction in image contrast, making it easier to capture scenes with a broad dynamic range, like balancing a bright sky with unreflective land. Thus, depending on how and where you use it, a well-angled polariser can make or break a perfect moment being captured.



Reduction of reflection via the use of a polariser

UV filters

One of the most commonly seen around are Ultraviolet (UV) filters, primarily used to protect the front element of a camera lens since they're clear and don't noticeably affect the image. We may not be seeing it, but we all know that we're surrounded by UV light all the time outdoors. What we don't know is that film, as well as video, often exhibit a greater sensitivity to what is to us invisible. UV rays can show up as a bluish colour cast with colour film or can cause low contrast haze that diminishes details, especially when viewing far away objects in colour or in black and white. With film cameras, UV filters reduce this haze and improve contrast by minimising the amount of UV light that reaches the film. However, UV filters also have the potential to decrease image quality by increasing lens flare, adding a slight colour tint or